

FIT LADDER • THE UNIVERSAL ENVELOPE

Every split reads the same way

A slide that outgrows its box becomes
several. Now it always becomes the same
shape: a cover that carries the masthead,
the body pages, and — only when earned —
a dedicated insight.

Cover, body, insight

- **Cover — always.** A masthead worth a lead-in: eyebrow, title, subtitle, lede
- **Body — the split content**, native pages, heading repeated, (cont.) from the second on
- **Key insight — its own page, only when earned.** The takeaway never shares a page
- **Below-note — the last body page**, one size down, a footnote of the content above it

Two kinds of trailing material

- A **key insight** is the run's takeaway — a whole page, centered, sized up
- A **below-note** is a footnote of the content above it — the last body page, one size down
- Before this, both shared one page — the wrong call for a takeaway
- Neither repeats per body page — that duplication was the original bug

Launch readiness

fourteen checks before the gate

Everything below has to read true before we ship —
the list is the gate, not a summary of it.

Launch readiness

fourteen checks before the gate



Signal intake wired



Scoring model calibrated



Decision log live



Calibration loop running



Weekly review scheduled

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate



Quarterly audit booked



Stakeholder map signed off



Risk register populated



Budget tracker reconciled



Hiring plan approved

Launch readiness (cont.)

fourteen checks before the gate

☐ Roadmap published

☐ Retrospective template ready

☐ Metrics review automated

☐ Customer interviews booked

Source: the launch board, reviewed every Thursday.

Launch readiness

fourteen checks before the gate

KEY INSIGHT

The gate is the list — nothing ships until every row is checked.

Where the quarter went

spend against plan

Four programs carried the quarter; the rest were holding patterns.

Where the quarter went

spend against plan

Signal intake

Rebuilt end to end; latency down from minutes to seconds.

Where the quarter went (cont.)

spend against plan

Scoring model

Recalibrated on eighteen months of outcomes,
then frozen.

Where the quarter went (cont.)

spend against plan

Decision log

Every call has a written owner, a date, and its evidence.

Where the quarter went (cont.)

spend against plan

Calibration loop

Weekly review closes the predicted-to-actual gap.

Where the quarter went (cont.)

spend against plan

Partner onboarding

Two of five signed; three await our security review.

Where the quarter went (cont.)

spend against plan

Audit readiness

Evidence pack drafted, gaps listed, none signed yet.

The three unfunded programs are listed in the appendix, not here.

Build versus buy versus delay

The full comparison →

Cost

- BUILD** High upfront, amortizes over years
- BUY** Predictable subscription, scales with seats
- DELAY** Zero now, compounds later

Speed

BUILD Slowest to first value

BUY Fastest to first value

DELAY Fastest of all, until it is not

Control

BUILD Full control of the roadmap

BUY Vendor roadmap, some influence

DELAY No roadmap at all

Risk

- BUILD** Execution risk concentrated in-house
- BUY** Vendor lock-in and pricing risk
- DELAY** Deferred risk, often the worst kind

Source: vendor evaluation, Q3 procurement review.

Build versus buy versus delay

KEY INSIGHT

The build option only pays off if we actually staff it — otherwise buy wins by default.

Systems of record

what holds the truth

01 Customer identity.

The CRM is authoritative; every downstream system reads it and none writes back.

02 Billing and entitlement.

The ledger holds invoices, credits, and what a customer may actually use.

03 Product telemetry.

Warehouse-derived, rebuilt nightly, never treated as evidence on its own.

04 Risk register.

The board pack is authoritative — reviewed quarterly, versioned, signed by counsel.

The invariant

- Every split run begins with **exactly one** cover and carries **at most one** key-insight page
- A below-note rides the **last body page** — never its own page, never repeated on every page
- A title-less slide has no masthead to cover with, so it keeps the plain partition — an empty accent field would be worse
- Nothing is dropped: every page is the source slide with spans **removed**, so no leaf can go missing

One move, one shape

*Cover → body →
insight*